

KF46 Expanded Version of Teachings

Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

0:01 OPENING

0:02 PRESENTING

0:06 KARIS CIRCULATION

0:07 GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS

0:08 MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING

KF Confession 11 presents one of our more difficult challenges as we heal:

We take responsibility for any damage that we have done.

All of us have inherited debts of misorientation. The Bible teaches that the misorientation of our ancestors and its effects have been passed on to us, and we have also been damaged by the misorientation of those around us.¹ We, too, have generated misorientation—we have damaged the material world, our communities, and our own lives. Let’s stop pretending that this isn’t so and get on with the glorious work of redeeming our debts. The spiritual discipline of meditation strengthens our ability to endure as we take responsibility for the damage we have caused.

The Sunlight Meditation

At this point in our training, we are already acquainted with various meditation techniques. Now, as we explore this next confession, we will be reviewing some of those techniques with this added emphasis: we will focus our minds on our foreheads and lift our eyes during the meditation.

Assume a meditation posture and gently close your eyes. Allow your body to regulate your breathing as you begin **Alternate Nostril Breathing**. *(Pause for 2 minutes)*

Pause and relax. *(Pause)* Now, with your eyes closed, imagine that you are sitting outside on a sunny day. Gently raise your eyes toward the sun without lifting your chin. You might feel a tiny stretch. Imagine warmth and light shining down on your forehead. Try to maintain that sensation throughout this meditation practice. As you breathe, you can use the **Maranatha Meditation** to help you focus. We will practice for three minutes. Let’s begin. *(Pause for 3 minutes)*

Pause. Take a deep breath and stretch. Gently open your eyes and re-engage with the meeting.

Our hymn of gratitude for this confession is *Great is Thy Faithfulness*.

Great is Thy faithfulness, O God my Father,
 There is no shadow of turning with Thee;
 Thou changest not, Thy compassions, they fail not.
 As Thou hast been Thou forever wilt be.²

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about this training?”)

0:20 KARIS CONFESSION

0:21 TOOLBOX

Here is KF Confession 11 once again:

We take responsibility for any damage that we have done.

In this confession, Nancy has used the word *damage*, which can also be understood in terms of debt. Restoring damage is like paying off a debt. It often feels tedious and burdensome because we have to expend resources that could be used for pursuing our idealized glory and maintaining the illusion that we can live free from limitations. We have all created debt through our own choices, and it hurts our pride to admit that life and God won’t magically cancel those debts for us. Taking responsibility for our debt requires “a long obedience” to a guiding principle, and this obedience is not a wasted effort; we are trained through practicing a long obedience.³

We can go into debt in every area of the MATH. We have already talked about financial debt, which interferes with our karis generosity and restricts our options. We go into practical debt when we refuse to develop and train—or even acknowledge—our abilities. We go into time debt when we overbook our schedules and use our time to support our illusions and compulsive needs. By doing the MATH, we evaluate the limitations of our available resources and can then determine whether we can afford to go ahead with our plans.

When we do the MATH, the final resource to consider is our health. Each human being is a matrix of soul, mind, emotions, and material body. If we neglect the limitations of that design, we will go into health debt. Waking up to the consequences of this neglect has brought many of us to Karis Fellowships.

I am including your health under KF Confession 11 because I believe that all of us have damaged our health in some way. God is inviting you to come to Him with the reality of your health and the limitations that it presents. Without health—whether physical, mental, emotional or spiritual—you cannot live a glorious life, but if you co-labor with God as your Guide and Physician, you can seek and rescue that which was lost. Your mind and soul have the capacity to comprehend the glory and love of God, and your body is the vehicle through which that glory and love are revealed. You are the evidence of the unseen reality of your Creator, and for His sake you need to restore your health. To do that you will need help.

Getting help to recover your health often requires that you expend the other resources in the MATH. For example, you need money to hire help, and you must allocate time to develop the abilities to care for the health of your body, mind, and soul. It’s never too late to improve your health, and improving your health is one of the best investments you can make. My husband and I are well over sixty years old, and yet we spend less resources on our health now than in the past. Continue to ask God and others for help, simplify

your life and expenditure, adventure into new possibilities—and when you find a path that works for you, pursue that path as a priority. You cannot follow your path without counting the cost. You will have to do the MATH.

People experience compromised health for a number of reasons. We may, for example, have been born with poor health, or we may have been damaged by adverse circumstances. That is all part of living in a messed-up world. However, we can improve compromised health for the glory of God. In fact, health limitations may be the very resistance you need to build the strong CORE muscles of a trustworthy character.⁴ Perhaps, one day, God might step into the material world and heal you, but in the meantime, as you live within the limitations of the health that is yours today, you can show Him that you are trustworthy. Live in the present reality of your health, but hold in your heart the possibility that if you are working to stay in the flow of orientation, God may one day meet you with the karis gift of healing. I know what I am talking about because I have experienced surprising, miraculous healing.

Our western conventional medicine was developed on the battlefield and designed as a quick fix to save lives. In today's neurotic world, however, our culture looks to modern medicine as a means of enjoying limit-free living without suffering any negative consequences. Fundamentally, conventional medicine is designed only to manage sickness, not to cure it. As one medical doctor put it, "Our healthcare system is cracked." Pharmaceutical solutions are very often destructive, but they continue to be the bread and butter of a multi-trillion-dollar industry that asserts political muscle. This industry is fueled by our fear of sickness, our unwillingness to take responsibility for our own health, and our longing to be free of symptoms as soon as possible.

I encourage you to take responsibility for your physical health and well-being. You might visit alternative practitioners who can help you heal naturally and avoid future health problems. Illness often robs us of the money, ability, and time that we need to find and explore our health solutions, so do your research before you are in a health crisis and running scared. Educate yourself now so that when you or someone you love gets sick, which is a certainty in this world, you will already know where to go for help. When I was diagnosed with cancer, I was able to make informed decisions about what to do and where to go for help because I had already explored my options for alternative healing.

We need strong CORE muscles to recover our True Self and faithfully carry out our mission. The struggle to find your healing path strengthens your CORE muscles. With a strong CORE you can be courageous, choose orientation, commit to reality, and endure, even when your pride or distress is inviting you back into slavery to the Idol. Before you find your healing path, you will have to expend some of your resources exploring your possibilities. Losses in the process are natural. They are part of your struggle and part of your training. With oriented eyes, learn to see loss as a natural result of living within limitations. Limitations narrow your playing field, focus your efforts, and train you in efficiency. Value these limitations for their part in helping you learn to ask, simplify, adventure, and set priorities.

Spend time with people who are recovering their health. Ask, seek, and knock. Talk to those who are already involved in recovery. Just as you would seek out a skilled doctor or plumber, you will need to look around for a skilled alternative practitioner or therapist. Alternative healers can often be found through the referral network of health-food stores, gyms, and yoga studios. Search for them on the web, but be sure to examine their reputation and skill set before you decide to pay for their services. You might ask KF members to recommend practitioners and therapies.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Jesus, open my eyes so that I might follow You on the path to optimal health. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about the Toolbox?”)

0:30 SHARING

1:00 BIBLE TEACHING

Let’s remind ourselves of KF Confession 11:

We take responsibility for any damage that we have done.

In this lesson, we will learn from a woman who unsuccessfully pursued her healing for twelve years. I wonder if we have the same level of determination that she had. She spent her limited resources of money, ability, and time—in essence her life—going to doctors, but she could not find a cure. Some of us know what she went through. I myself have spent over forty years pursuing my healing, and about thirty years ago this woman’s story became a special promise to me. I felt that the Lord was telling me to just keep seeking His kingdom and orientation while exploring the path of healing. Since receiving that promise, I have experienced miraculous healing, and I have also found substantial healing through conventional and alternative medicine. Through enduring that long struggle, I gained the self-confidence that I have today. I learned to appreciate my efforts and clarify my priorities. I also learned where my character lacked a strong CORE. Without those years of struggle, Karis Fellowships would not exist.

This is my translation of **Luke 8:43–48**.

⁴³And there was a woman in the crowd who had been hemorrhaging for twelve years. She spent her life going to doctors and none of them were able to heal her. ⁴⁴She came up behind Jesus and touched the fringe of His robe. Immediately, the bleeding stopped. ⁴⁵“Who touched me?” Jesus asked. Everyone denied it, and Peter said, “Master, this whole crowd is pressing up against you.” ⁴⁶But Jesus told him, “Someone touched me, for I felt healing power go out from me.” ⁴⁷When the woman saw that her actions were not hidden, she began to tremble and fell to her knees before Jesus. The whole crowd heard her declare that she was the one who had touched Him and that she had been immediately healed. ⁴⁸“Daughter,” He said to her, “your trust has made you whole. Go forward in peace.”

Take a deep breath.

In this passage, we might notice how the sick woman took responsibility for her physical damage, or debt, and through that process found Jesus. She was an unusual woman living outside the common roles of her society. Like many members of Karis Fellowships, she was driven by desperate need to abandon the conventions of her culture and pursue the healing that only comes from a relationship with Jesus.

1. She had already put lots of effort into her healing

Before Jesus healed her, the woman had already made her physical healing a priority, and that priority was factored into all of her life decisions. She had been doing ASAP—ask, simplify, adventure, and set priorities—for a long time. She was probably spending a lot more of her limited resources on seeking

health than on giving to ministries or doing good works. My church and family culture did not teach me to take care of myself, nor did they teach me that my health was a priority. Honestly, for my own sake, and for the Lord's, I wish that I had invested more of my resources in recovering my health. Instead, I compulsively gave my resources away.

2. She was very assertive about the importance of her health

This suffering woman was no longer a passive recipient of the ministrations of doctors. She believed that her health was her responsibility, and she didn't let pride, conventions, social roles, or her fears stand in her way as she pursued health. She was probably the kind of patient who told doctors what she needed and cooperated with them to figure out her problem. She cooperated with them until she knew that they had nothing more to offer. Then she moved on.

3. She had learned courage and endurance while making oriented choices in the real world

Her ill-health was a reality. The long years of living with debilitating health had taught her courage, orientation, how to grapple with reality, and endurance. When she saw her opportunity in Jesus, she used her CORE muscles to grab Him.

4. She had learned to be honest and speak her reality with self-confidence

It's scary to touch the unseen and get instantly healed. Another world opens up to you, like the ability to fly when you have unwittingly fallen out of the nest. Through the long years of struggle, this woman had trained herself to act in the moment according to her beliefs, despite her fear. She was able to honestly answer Jesus with humility and truth without worrying about what others might think or how they might judge. The whole crowd was invited to hear her declare the reality of her healing.

5. Jesus said that her faith, or her action based on her trust, had saved her

The woman's choices in the material world were the evidence of what she believed in her heart. This partnership of ideas and action made her whole. The Greek word for *whole* is commonly translated as *saved*. Wholeness comes when we live congruently as the children of God—when our choices reflect our oriented beliefs. We are then unified and complete. We are glorious.

6. Her choices make her healing happen

Perhaps the most important lesson that we can learn from this story is that the woman's will, and not the will of Jesus, makes her healing happen. I would guess that she is a woman of prayer and practice. She is healed after her character has developed and her desires have become clear and focused. She has learned how to bring her body into harmony with the Creation and access the power of God. There are many desperate, sick people in the world who do not get well. One difference between them and this woman is training and effort. Desperation alone does not get her well. During her long years of struggle, she has acquired a taste for action, so when her opportunity comes, she is ready to throw off her taboos and act. She reaches out to Jesus based on her trust in Him. Jesus commends this congruence of belief (or trust) and action, which brings her peace. Her internal conflict is finally resolved. She is saved, unified, and complete, and her physical health in the seen world now reflects the unseen reality of her soul.

Make your health a priority. Restore your own spiritual, physical, mental, and emotional health so that you can journey forward in peace. No one can do it for you. You must take action and learn how to touch Jesus for yourself.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Jesus, help me train today so that one day I might touch You and become whole. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?")

1:10 INTEGRATION

Sip some clean water and, if you wish, prepare to take some notes. Assume your meditation posture, and breathe. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Here is our integration focus: *Consider an area of health—whether spiritual, physical, mental, or emotional—that continues to invite restoration. (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

The FAITH Process

(Choose from each section a few sentences that are meaningful to you)

Feelings

As you consider *an area of health—whether spiritual, physical, mental, or emotional—that continues to invite restoration*, how does it feel? *(Pause)* Your feelings are yours to teach you about yourself, to guide you, and to train you. They can often be uncomfortable. *(Pause)* Recognize with compassion whatever you are experiencing, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Awareness without judgment

Allow your experience to rest in your awareness as you *consider this area of health*. You might notice a compulsion to make up a virtue story or to push away thoughts and feelings. We often flush away thoughts and feelings before they have a chance to teach us. Observe whatever tension you might be feeling, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Inquiry: What is my body saying?

Bring your attention to your body and notice what it is doing when you *consider this area of health that continues to invite restoration*. What sensations are there? *(Pause)* Your body is always talking to you. You may not understand its language right now, but you can observe. For example, you might recognize what denial or hopelessness feels like in your body. You might feel inspired. Breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Talk to Jesus

You might imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider this area of health—whether spiritual, physical, mental, or emotional—that continues to invite restoration*. Do you judge the need for restoration as good or evil? *(Pause)* What do you believe when you think about this area? What story do you want to tell? *(Pause)* Are you afraid of something? Observe your responses as just information, and breathe with a long exhaling breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Heal

As you breathe, repeat the word *Welcome*. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

(Pause for 8 seconds or one long breath after each statement)

- Welcome this opportunity to explore your health.
- Welcome the gentle Holy Spirit of truth as He seeks to heal and make you whole.
- Welcome the present reality of your health and the progress you have made.

- Welcome what you are learning about yourself. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Now, as you breathe, you might use the following statements as a confession to the Lord and turn away from the Idol Self. On the exhale, let go.⁵

(Pause for 5 seconds after each statement)

- As I begin to honor my health, I let go of the longing to have things go my way.
- As I begin to honor my health, I let go of the longing for self-satisfaction and admiration.
- As I begin to honor my health, I let go of the longing for security and comfort.
- As I begin to honor my health, I let go of the longing for perfection. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Pause. Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?")

1:28 ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for drawing us together to learn and to heal. Hold us in the power of new vision as You guide us to wholeness. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we cooperate with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to further our connection with our mission, with the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting?")

1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS

*If you are the Karis Link to someone in the NHG study, be sure to check in with them and see how they are doing. If they wish to join KF, help them understand that they must meet the requirements of attendance and completed homework. You might attend one of the NHG lessons yourself to refresh your understanding of your own process. You can check the website for the schedule and contact numbers.

*(*Except in the Jubilee Year)*

¹ Num. 14:18.

² *Great is Thy Faithfulness* by Thomas Chisholm (1866–1960), www.youtube.com/watch?v=dTKlqmdfHSk.

³ www.adamsetser.com/blog/2015/5/9/a-long-obedience-in-the-same-direction-the-meaning-of-life-from-friedrich-nietzsche-and-king-solomon.

⁴ See KF32.

⁵ www.camillecaldwell.com/WelcomePrayer.html. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.